

— EDITION 22

Why we batch payments, and why it is about to matter again.

A payment can cost more to record than it is worth. That problem is as old as ACH, and micro-payments are about to revive it.

A 7-part breakdown

SWIPE >>>>

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The cost of writing a payment down.

Every payment is a database write, a record, a reconciliation. Below a certain value, the bookkeeping costs more than the payment itself.

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| Why ACH batches.

It is not laziness. Grouping thousands of payments into one file and settling them together is how you make small payments economic. The batch is the answer to a cost problem.

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What I learned watching batches fail.

A failed batch is thousands of payments sharing one problem. You scope it, isolate the bad record, release the rest, and race the cutoff. Volume changes everything.

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| The new pressure.

Pay-per-use software and tiny machine payments want to charge fractions of a cent. Settle each one alone and the write cost buries the payment.

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| The same old fix.

Aggregate. Net thousands of tiny events into one settlement. Whether you call it batching or streaming, it is the idea ACH had decades ago.

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| Why it matters now.

The teams that win micro-payments will not invent new money. They will rediscover netting and apply it at a new scale.

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| Save this.

When the payment is smaller than the paperwork, you batch. That rule is not going anywhere.

— THE TAKEAWAY

What would you meter?

Comment what you'd price per-use if clearing were free. Repost to share it, and follow for daily agentic payments breakdowns.

◆ Joseph Bankole